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Senior Developer (Ref: 23197)

Ministry of Justice

Apply before 11:55 pm on Monday 9th November 2026

Reference number

485803

Salary

£58,511 - £70,725

The national salary range is £58,511 - £65,329, London salary range is £63,343 - £70,725 Your salary will be dependent on your base location

Salary Information**

Base salary for this role is from: £63,343 - £73,875 [London] & £58,511 - £69,150 [National]

New entrants to the Civil Service joining the MoJ are expected to start at the minimum of the pay band.

Existing Civil Servants moving on a level transfer will retain their current base salary or move to the minimum of the pay band for the role, whichever is higher.

Existing Civil Servants who are promoted will either move to the bottom of the new grade s pay band or receive a 10% uplift, whichever provides the greater increase.

Candidates may also be eligible for a non-pensionable Government Digital & Data Allowance of up to £10,532 per year (London) or £10,639 (National). This is a temporary allowance, reviewed annually and may be retained, amended, or withdrawn.

The final offer will reflect the skills and experience you demonstrate during the assessment process.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7
Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Part-time

Number of jobs available

20

Contents

Location
About the job
Benefits
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Apply and further information

Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, Scotland, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This position is based Nationally

Job description

Senior Developer

Location: National*

Closing Date: 9th November

Interviews: Beginning from week commencing 19th October

Grade: Grade 7

(MoJ candidates who are on a specialist grade, will be able to retain this grade on lateral transfer)

Salary:**

£63,343 - £73,875 which may include an allowance up to £10,532 [London]

£58,511 - £69,150 which may include an allowance up to £10,639 [National]

Working pattern: Full-time, Part-time, Flexible working

Contract Type: Permanent

Number of vacancies: 20

Vacancy number: 23197

***We offer a hybrid working model, allowing for a balance between remote work and time spent in your local office. Office locations can be found ON THIS MAP**
Please note that unless you are an existing member of staff at Justice Digital, Data and Science, the only London location being recruited to is 10 South Colonnade, E14 4PU. We are no longer recruiting to 102 Petty France, SW1H 9AJ.

The Role

Please note this role requires you to pass Security Check clearance. Please click on the link for details.

We re recruiting for Senior Developers here at Justice Digital, Data and Science to be part of our warm and collaborative HMPPS team.

This role aligns against Senior Developer from the Government Digital and Data Framework

You ll be confident working with other developers on our tech stack and comfortable learning new technologies and systems. We use a variety of different technologies and will work with you to place you in a team that matches your skills, interests and aspirations wherever possible.

As a Senior Developer, you could be working on projects such as**:**

- Improving how prison visits are scheduled and managed.
- Building digital services that help Probation staff support rehabilitation and prepare cases for court.

- Designing services that manage identity data safely and accurately across prisons and probation.
- Modernising legacy systems used by frontline staff, making them easier to use, maintain and improve.
- Building APIs and shared services that allow information to move safely between different parts of the justice system.
- Automating manual processes so staff can spend less time on administration and more time supporting people in prison and on probation.

You will work in multidisciplinary teams with user researchers, product managers, designers, delivery managers, technical architects and content specialists who share a vision for improving government through smarter use of technology.

Our Tech Stack

We use a range of modern technologies, and we re looking for developers with strong experience in one or more of them, as well as an enthusiasm for learning new languages, tools and frameworks.

Our services are commonly built using **Kotlin and Node.js**. We use **GitHub Actions** for CI/CD, tools including **Application Insights**, **Grafana** and **Sentry** for application monitoring and observability, and **Docker** and **Kubernetes** to package and run our services. Much of our infrastructure runs on **AWS**, supported by the Ministry of Justice Cloud Platform.

For web interfaces, we use the **GOV.UK Design System** and **MOJ Design System** and place a strong emphasis on accessible, user-centred services.

For front-end development, we value a strong understanding of the underlying web technologies. We favour well-maintained, open-source tools and aim to produce semantic **HTML**, performant **CSS**, and maintainable, unobtrusive **JavaScript or TypeScript**. Accessibility is a core part of how we design, build and assess our services.

You don t need to have used exactly the same technologies as us. We re happy to help you learn our stack, and we re more interested in strong

engineering fundamentals and your ability to pick up new technologies. For more detail on our tech stack, look at the MoJ Technical Radar.

You can explore the Ministry of Justice GitHub organisation to see examples of the services we build and maintain.

We work in agile, multidisciplinary teams and follow the principles of the Manifesto for Agile Software Development.

Our developers are provided with **MacBook Pros** for their day-to-day work.

Our Community

You ll be joining a large and supportive engineering community across the Ministry of Justice, with developers working on services used throughout prisons, probation and the wider justice system.

As a Senior Developer, you ll help coach and mentor other developers, share your knowledge, and contribute to communities of practice across MoJ. We encourage developers to get involved beyond their immediate team through technical discussions, talks, meet-ups, open-source projects and shared engineering initiatives.

We take supportive and effective line management seriously. We ll value the experience and skills you bring, while helping you develop further through coaching, learning opportunities and exposure to different teams and technologies.

As your career develops, there are opportunities to move between teams, take on different technical challenges and progress into roles with greater technical or leadership responsibility.

To get a feel for how we work, take a look at the Ministry of Justice Developer Portal or the Justice Digital blog.

You ll receive a range of excellent benefits when you join our department, including:

- **A generous employer pension contribution of 28.97%** through the Civil Service Pension Scheme.

25 days of annual leave, (increasing to 30 days once you have reached 5 years of service), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King s birthday.

Flexible working arrangements including hybrid working, working part time or compressed hours. Designed to support a positive work life balance.

Employees are allocated **10% of their working time for personal and professional development.**

A £1k per person learning budget is in place to support all our people, with access to best-in-class conferences and seminars, accreditation with professional bodies, fully funded vocational programmes and e-learning platforms.

Compassionate maternity, adoption, and shared parental leave policies, with up to 26 weeks leave at full pay, 13 weeks with partial pay, and 13 weeks further leave. And maternity support/paternity leave at full pay for 2 weeks, too!

You can find more details of the Benefits we offer here**.** To help picture your life at MoJ Justice Digital, Data and Science please take a look at our blog.

Key Responsibilities:

As a Senior Software Developer at the MoJ, you ll combine hands-on technical work with supporting and developing the people around you.

Technical responsibilities

Designing, building and maintaining secure APIs, services and systems

Working collaboratively on existing codebases, helping to understand and improve them over time

Improving the resilience, reliability and maintainability of our software

Using practices that support safe, frequent and sustainable delivery

Supporting people and teams

Supporting the development of others through line management, coaching and mentoring

- Working closely with Lead Developers and colleagues to create supportive, effective teams
- Sharing knowledge and creating opportunities for others to learn and grow
- Helping to build and sustain a diverse, inclusive and welcoming development community, where different perspectives are valued

If this sounds like work you d enjoy and you re interested in joining a supportive development community, we d love to hear from you.

Person Specification

Essential Criteria

You will:

- Solve problems in a systematic and innovative way
- Champion software maintenance, clean code, coding standards and modern development and deployment techniques
- Enjoy sharing knowledge, mentoring, coaching and working in a multi-disciplinary team
- Thrive when you work as part of a team that abides by the spirit of the manifesto of agile software development
- Communicate technical information to a range of audiences
- Hold yourself and others to a high standard
- Demonstrate experience of delivering large and complex software solutions
- Demonstrate experience working in Java, Kotlin, TypeScript or JavaScript

Willingness to be assessed against the requirements for SC clearance

We welcome the unique contribution diverse applicants bring and do not discriminate based on culture, ethnicity, race, nationality or national origin, age, sex, gender identity or expression, religion or belief, disability status, sexual orientation, educational or social background or any other factor.

Our values are Purpose, Humanity, Openness and Together. Find out more here about how we celebrate diversity and an inclusive culture in our workplace.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Salary Information**

Base salary for this role is from: £63,343 - £73,875 [London] & £58,511 - £69,150 [National]

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Candidates may also be eligible for a non-pensionable Government Digital & Data Allowance of up to £10,532 per year (London) or £10,639 (National). This is a temporary allowance, reviewed annually and may be retained, amended, or withdrawn.

The final offer will reflect the skills and experience you demonstrate during the assessment process.

Person specification

Please refer to Job Description

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £58,511, Ministry of Justice contributes £16,950 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension

scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

- Access to learning and development
- A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance
- A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity
- A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%
- Annual Leave
- Public Holidays
- Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

How to Apply

In Justice Digital, Data and Science, we recruit using a combination of the **Government Digital and Data Profession Capability** and **Success Profiles** Frameworks. We shall assess a combination of your Experience, Technical skills and Behaviours during the assessment process.

Stage 1 - Application and sift:

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application:

A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Person Specification of this advert.

A **Personal Statement** (no more than 750 words) which should outline your experience and skills, giving clear examples of work undertaken. It should specifically address the following 3 criteria listed below, using a separate paragraph for each.

Demonstrate experience of delivering large and complex software solutions

Use modern development and deployment techniques

Enjoy sharing knowledge and working in a multi-disciplinary team

Candidates who do not adhere to the Personal Statement directions above may be rejected on this basis.

A diverse sift panel will review the information in your CV and Personal Statement to assess the sift criteria specified above. We operate an anonymous shortlisting process. Please ensure your CV and Personal Statement do not include your name or any other identifying details.

Should we receive a high volume of applications, a pre-sift based on Demonstrate proven experience working in Java, Kotlin, TypeScript or JavaScript will be conducted before the sift.

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - Application Guidance

Stage 2 - Interviews:

Successful candidates who meet the required standard will then be invited to a panel interview held via Microsoft Teams. At interview stage, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements - Experience, Technical and the following Behaviours:

Making effective decisions

Working together

Developing self and others

Communicating and influencing

As part of your interview, you will be asked to take part in a technical test which will entail conducting a code review using one of our core development languages as outlined in the person specification above.

Appointments are made strictly in merit order. In the event that two or more candidates receive identical interview scores, relevant technical experience will be applied as the primary lead criterion to determine the final merit order.

Should you be unsuccessful in the role that you have applied for but demonstrate the capability for a role at a lower level, we reserve the right to discuss this opportunity with you and offer you the position without needing a further application.

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months, from which further appointments may be made.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone :	0345 241 5359
Recruitment team	
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission s Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (Moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints/

https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?isPreview=Yes&jobid=1245

Civil Service Commission

disability confident EMPLOYER